

ALGORITHMS IN AI & DATA SCIENCE 1 (AKIDS 1)

Sorting

Prof. Dr. Goran Glavaš

Content

- Sorting
- Merge Sort
- Quick Sort

Sorting problem

- How do we measure time complexity?
 - In terms of **number of elementary operations executed**
 - How does that number **depend on the input**? What is the **size of the problem**?
 - What about the operations that do not depend on the **size of the input**?
- Let us go back to the **sorting problem**...

Sorting Problem

Input: A sequence of n numbers $\langle a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n \rangle$

(Desired) Output: A permutation (reordering) of the input $\langle a'_1, a'_2, \dots, a'_n \rangle$ such that

$$a'_1 \leq a'_2 \leq \dots \leq a'_n$$

Why Sorting?

- Sorting is considered to be the **most fundamental problem** in the study of algorithms
 - Some applications are basically directly expressible as sorting problems
 - E.g., Banks are legally obliged to issue checks in sorted order
 - Companies must issue invoices in some order
 - Many algorithms use sorting as a component, i.e., a subroutine
 - There's a **wide variety of sorting algorithms**: they use **techniques and data structures** used in more complex algorithms too
 - Good starting point for „**algorithmic thinking**”
 - We can prove a **nontrivial lower-bound complexity for sorting**, and also know that the best sorting algorithms reach this bound asymptotically
 - This can be used to prove lower-bound complexity for more complex problems

Keys and Records

comparison

central elementary operation in all sorting algorithms

- All examples will sort **numbers**
 - How do we sort items of other data types?
 - We just need to define a comparison operator for other primitive types
 - E.g., strings can be converted into integers. **Q**: how?
- We typically sort more complex items („**records**”), with **key** being the numeric field of the record based on which we sort
 - The rest of the record is just moved together with the key

65	17	27	45
Max	Dalya	Marcin	Monika
Mustermann	Prost	Kovalyev	Seles

→ keys for sorting

Lower-bound complexity

- A **lower bound** for a problem is the **worst-case running time of the best (most efficient) possible algorithm** that solves the problem
- Q: Lower-bound for **sorting**?
- So far, we've seen only one sorting algorithm: **Insert(ion) sort**
 - Insert sort has the quadratic complexity, it's running time is in **$O(n^2)$**
 - A sorting algorithm with **lower/better worst-case running time**?
 - A sorting algorithm of linear complexity: in **$O(n)$** ?

Insert sort

Sorting Problem

Input: A sequence of n numbers $\langle a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n \rangle$

(Desired) Output: A permutation (reordering) of the input $\langle a'_1, a'_2, \dots, a'_n \rangle$ such that

$$a'_1 \leq a'_2 \leq \dots \leq a'_n$$

Algorithm: **insert(ion) sort**

```
insert_sort(L) # L is a list of numbers
  for i = 1 to L.length - 1 # 0-indexing, first element is at index 0, last at len-1
    key = L[i]
    j = i-1
    while j > -1 and L[j] > key
      L[j+1] = L[j]
      j = j - 1
    L[j+1] = key
```



Image from Cormen et al.

Insert sort: running time

Algorithm: **insert(ion) sort**

```
insert_sort(L)
  for i = 1 to L.length - 1 # (n-1) * c1
    key = L[i] # (n-1) * c2
    j = i-1 # (n-1) * c3
    while j > -1 and L[j] > key #  $\sum_{i=1}^{n-1} c_4 * t_i$ 
      L[j+1] = L[j] #  $\sum_{i=1}^{n-1} c_5 * (t_i - 1)$ 
      j = j - 1 #  $\sum_{i=1}^{n-1} c_6 * (t_i - 1)$ 
    L[j+1] = key # (n-1) * c7
```

- Total running time **T(n)**

$$T(n) = (n-1) * (c_1 + c_2 + c_3 + c_7) + \sum_{i=1}^{n-1} c_4 * t_i + (c_5 + c_6) * (t_i - 1)$$

- What is the **worst possible** scenario (largest possible running time)?

- If the input **L** is inversely sorted (from largest to smallest value)

- $t_i = i$ for each i

- $\sum_{i=1}^{n-1} c_4 * t_i = (1 + 2 + \dots + (n-1)) * c_4 = \frac{(n-1)*n}{2} * c_4$

- $\sum_{i=1}^{n-1} c_5 * (t_i - 1) = (0 + 1 + \dots + (n-2)) * c_5 = \frac{(n-2)*(n-1)}{2} * c_5$

- $\sum_{i=1}^{n-1} c_6 * (t_i - 1) = (0 + 1 + \dots + (n-2)) * c_6 = \frac{(n-2)*(n-1)}{2} * c_6$

Insert sort: running time

Algorithm: **insert(ion) sort**

```
insert_sort(L)
  for i = 1 to L.length - 1 # (n-1) * c1
    key = L[i] # (n-1) * c2
    j = i-1 # (n-1) * c3
    while j > -1 and L[j] > key #  $\sum_{i=1}^{n-1} c_4 * t_i$ 
      L[j+1] = L[j] #  $\sum_{i=1}^{n-1} c_5 * (t_i - 1)$ 
      j = j - 1 #  $\sum_{i=1}^{n-1} c_6 * (t_i - 1)$ 
    L[j+1] = key # (n-1) * c7
```

- Total running time **T(n)**

$$T(n) = (n-1) * (c_1 + c_2 + c_3 + c_7) + \sum_{i=1}^{n-1} c_4 * t_i + (c_5 + c_6) * (t_i - 1)$$

- What is the **worst possible** scenario (largest possible running time)?

- If the input **L** is inversely sorted (from largest to smallest value)

- $t_i = i$ for each i

- $T(n) = (n-1) * (c_1 + c_2 + c_3 + c_7) + \frac{(n-1)*n}{2} * c_4 + \frac{(n-2)*(n-1)}{2} * (c_5 + c_6)$

- $T(n) = a*n^2 + b*n + c$

- This is a **quadratic function of n** → **O(n²)**

Rates of growth and complexity

- Growth rates for some common complexity functions

- $\Theta(1)$ (constant)
- $\Theta(\log n)$ (logarithmic)
- $\Theta(n)$ (linear)
- $\Theta(n \log n)$ (loglinear)
- $\Theta(n^2)$ (quadratic complexity)
- $\Theta(n^3)$ (cubic complexity)
 - ... $\Theta(n^k)$ for $k \geq 0$ (polynomial)
- $\Theta(2^n)$ (exponential)
- $\Theta(n!)$ (factorial)

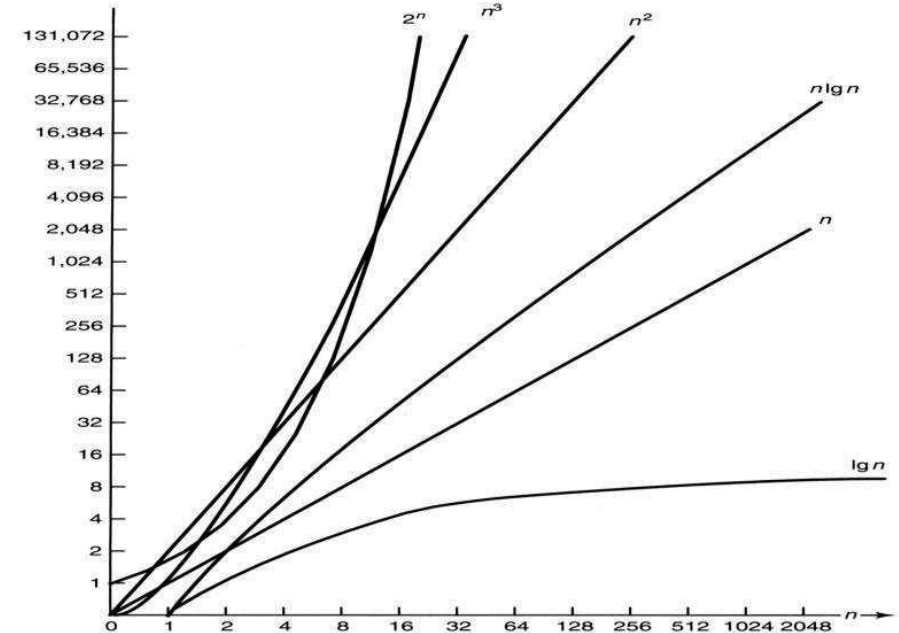


Image from <https://tinyurl.com/46c3cssy>

Sorting algorithms

- We will not only consider time complexity, but also **space complexity**
 - Space is normally **not an issue**, but to emphasize **space-time trade-off**
- **In-place** sorting
 - Algorithm that only needs to store **a constant number of elements** from the input array **outside of that array**
 - Is **insert(ion) sort** an in-place sorting algorithm?
 - How many elements are stored outside of the input array at any given time?
- When sorting **very large arrays**, „**in-place**” **sorting** becomes important

Sorting and algorithm design techniques

- When building algorithms, we often resort to some common **algorithm design techniques**

- **Insert sort:** sorting based on **incremental** approach

- Having sorted the subarray $L[0:i-1]$

- We proceed to insert the i -th element into the correct place

- This yields the correct sorting for the subarray $L[0:i]$

```
insert_sort(L)
  for i = 1 to L.length - 1
    key = L[i]
    j = i-1
    while j > -1 and L[j] > key
      L[j+1] = L[j]
      j = j - 1
    L[j+1] = key
```

Sorting and algorithm design techniques

- When building algorithms, we often resort to some common **algorithm design techniques**
- Sorting based on **divide-and-conquer** approach (**recursion!**)
- **Divide-and-conquer:**
 - **DIVIDE**: divide the problem into a number of subproblems that are smaller instances of the same problem
 - **CONQUER**: solve the subproblems
 - if the size of the subproblem is small enough, solve it the straightforward way
 - If the size of the subproblem is still large, **DIVIDE** it further
 - **COMBINE**: create the solution to the super problem (parent problem) by combining the solutions to the subproblems (children problems)

Content

- Sorting
- Merge Sort
- Quick Sort

Merge Sort

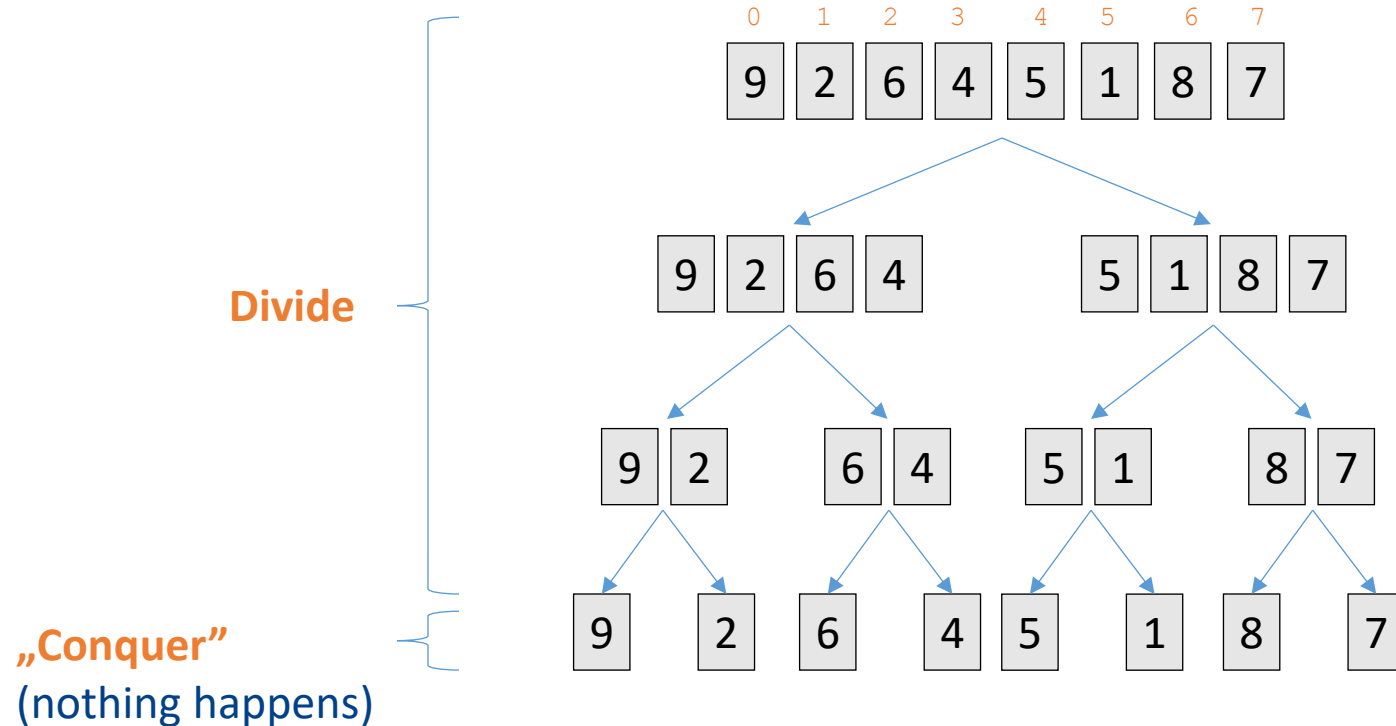
Merge Sort implements the „divide-and-conquer” algorithm design

- **DIVIDE**: divide the n -element input array to be sorted into two subarrays of length $n/2$ each
- **CONQUER**: sort each of the subarrays recursively (the recursion hits the „bottom” when the subarray to be sorted is of length 1)
- **COMBINE**: Merge the sorted subarrays to produce the sorted array
 - Key is the **merge function** here, otherwise merge sort is a simple recursion

Merge Sort: illustration

Divide until reaching single-element subarrays

Conquer: trivial – „sort one-element arrays” (nothing happens really)

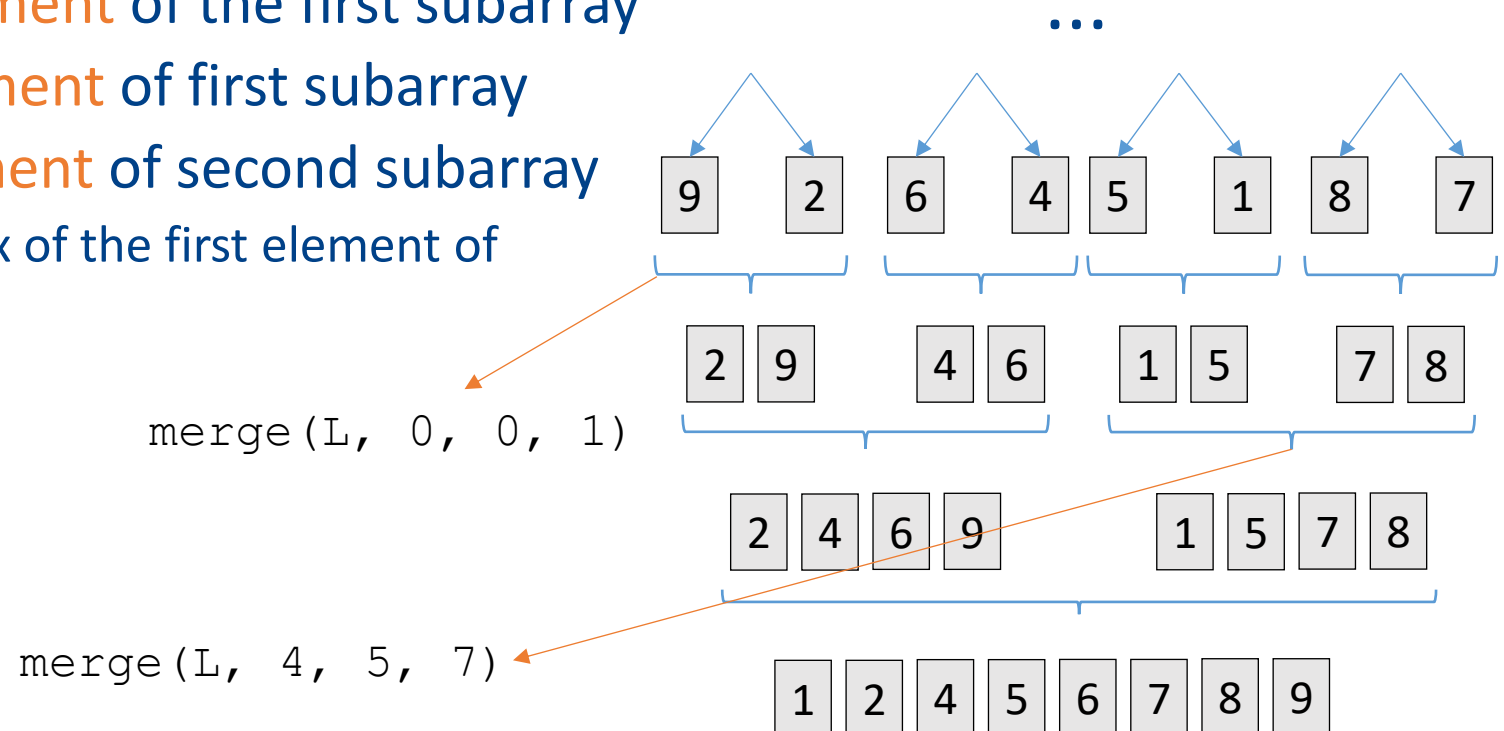


Merge Sort: illustration

Combine: merge two **sorted** subarrays into a sorted array

We need to define the critical **merge** (**A**, **p**, **q**, **r**) function

- **A**: the input array
- **p**: index of **first element** of the first subarray
- **q**: index of **last element** of first subarray
- **r**: index of **last element** of second subarray
 - **Q**: what's the index of the first element of second subarray?



Merge Sort: merge function

```
merge(A, p, q, r)
    n_left = q - p + 1 # number of elements in the left subarray
    n_right = r - q # number of elements in the right subarray
    L = array[n_left] # create the left subarray
    R = array[n_right] # create the right subarray
    # copy the elements from the original array into subarrays
    for i = 0 to n_left - 1:
        L[i] = A[p + i]
    for j = 0 to n_right - 1:
        R[j] = A[q + 1 + j]
    # the real „merging“ starts now
    ind_l = 0
    ind_r = 0
    for k = p to r
        if L[ind_l] ≤ R[ind_r] or ind_r > n_right - 1
            A[k] = L[ind_l]
            ind_l = ind_l + 1
        else
            A[k] = R[ind_r]
            ind_r = ind_r + 1
```

Merge sort: merge function

- What is the running time of the **merge** function?
- What is the „input size“ **n**?
 - Length of (sub)array under consideration: $r - p + 1$
 - Consists of two subarrays
- If we ignore the constant runtime costs, we get

$$n/2 + n/2 + n = 2n = O(n)$$

```
merge(A, p, q, r)
    n_left = q - p + 1
    n_right = r - q
    L = array[n_left]
    R = array[n_right]
    for i = 0 to n_left - 1: # runtime = n/2
        L[i] = A[p + i]
    for j = 0 to n_right - 1: # runtime = n/2
        R[j] = A[q + 1 + j]
    ind_l = 0
    ind_r = 0
    for k = p to r # runtime = n
        if ind_r > n_right - 1 or L[ind_l] ≤ R[ind_r]
            A[k] = L[ind_l]
            ind_l = ind_l + 1
        else
            A[k] = R[ind_r]
            ind_r = ind_r + 1
```

Merge sort

- Now that we have defined the merge function, let's see the whole **recursive merge sort** algorithm

```
merge_sort(A, p, r)
    n = r - p + 1
    if n % 2 == 1 # odd number of elements
        q = p + n//2 # a//b is integer division, 7//2 = 3
    else # even number of elements
        q = p + n/2 - 1

    merge_sort(A, p, q)
    merge_sort(A, q + 1, r)
    merge(A, p, q, r)
```

Merge sort: runtime

- Runtime of the `merge` function is $2n = O(n)$
- Merge-sort on 1-element array
 - Constant time (nothing actually), $O(1)$
- When $n > 1$
 - **DIVIDE**: just computes the middle of the subarray, constant time →
 - $D(n) = O(1)$
 - **CONQUER**: recursively sort two subproblems of size $n/2$
 - $C(n) = 2 * T(n/2)$
 - **COMBINE** (`merge`): runtime of the `merge` function
 - $M(n) = O(n)$

```
merge_sort(A, p, r)
    n = r - p + 1
    if n % 2 == 1
        q = p + n//2
    else
        q = p + n/2 - 1

    merge_sort(A, p, q)
    merge_sort(A, q + 1, r)
    merge(A, p, q, r)
```

Merge sort: runtime

DIVIDE: $D(n) = O(1)$

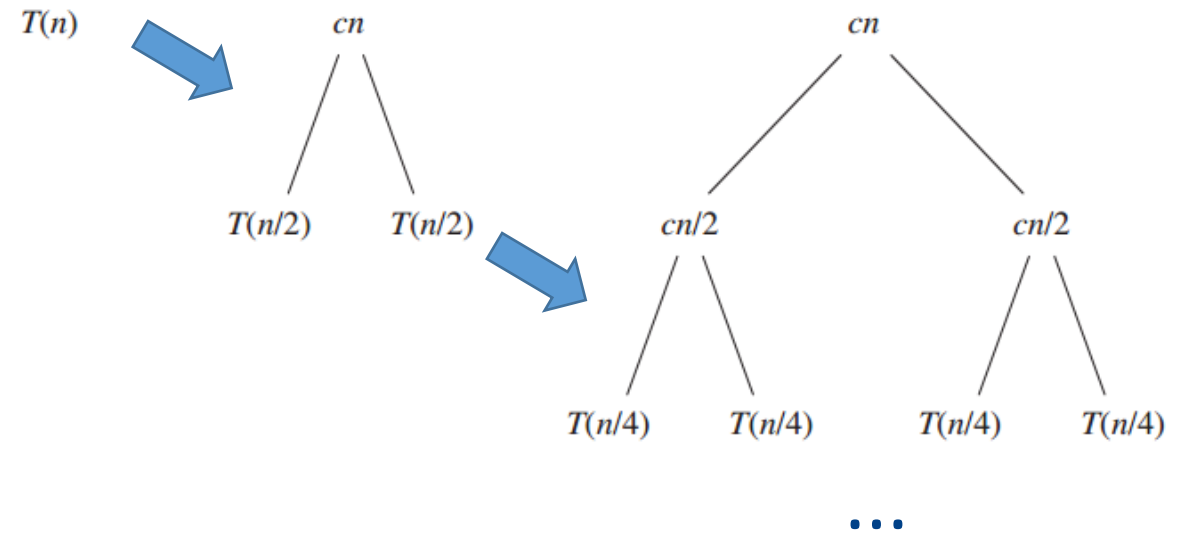
CONQUER: $C(n) = 2 * T(n/2)$

COMBINE (merge): $M(n) = O(n)$

- Summing $D(n) + M(n)$ gives $O(n) + O(1) = O(n)$
- So, $T(n)$ for **merge sort** is
 - $O(1)$, if $n = 1$
 - $2 * T(n/2) + O(n)$, if $n > 1$ (recursively defined runtime)
- Or, removing the O notation, introducing the constants, $T(n) =$
 - c , if $n = 1$
 - $2 * T(n/2) + c * n$, if $n > 1$

Merge sort: runtime

- So, $T(n)$ is
 - c , if $n = 1$
 - $2 * T(n/2) + c * n$, if $n > 1$
- Recursive runtime computation
 - $T(n/2) = 2 * T(n/4) + c * n/2$
 - $T(n/4) = 2 * T(n/8) + c * n/4$
 - ...
 - $T(n = 1) = c$



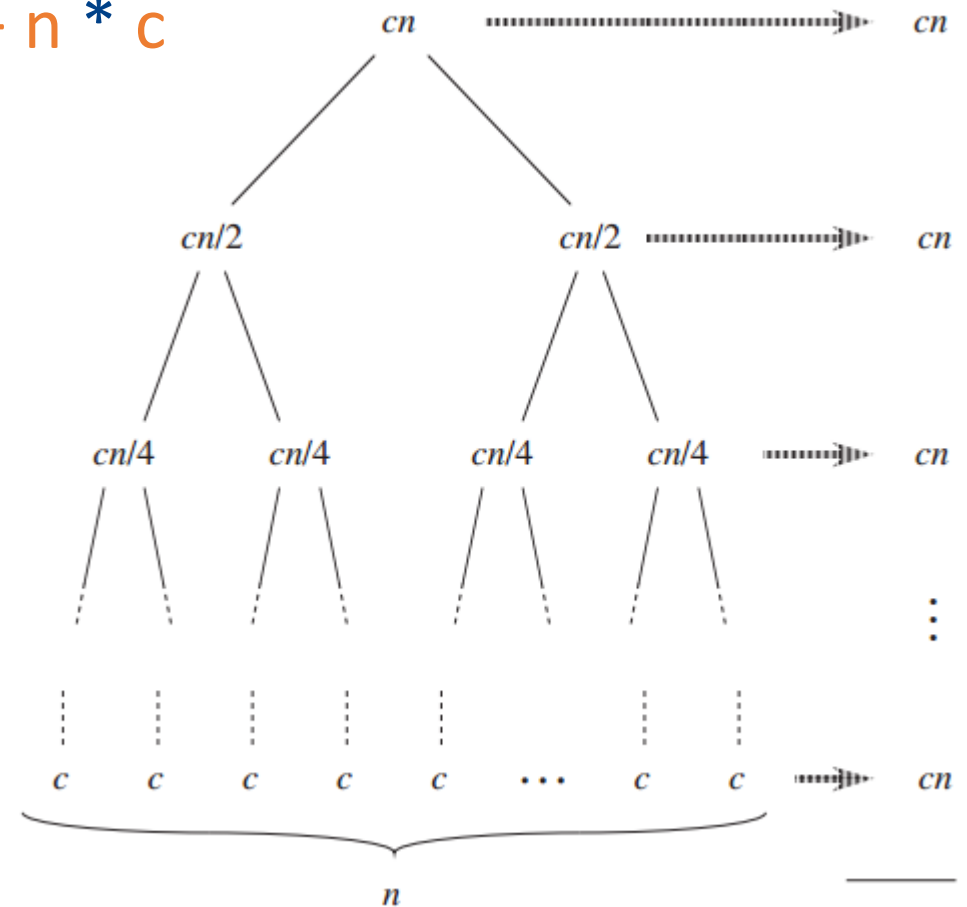
(Adapted) Image from Cormen et al.

Merge sort: runtime

- $$T(n) = c*n + 2*c*n/2 + 4*c*n/4 + \dots + n * c$$
$$= \underbrace{c*n + c*n + c*n + \dots + c*n}$$

How many times
do we have $c*n$?

- Depth of the tree = $\log_2 n$
- $T(n) = c*n * \log_2 n = O(n \log n)$



Merge sort: space complexity

- **Q:** Is merge sort an „in place” sorting algorithm?
- How much **additional** memory does it need besides **A**?
 - Is that additional memory of constant size or depends on **n**?
- In `merge` function, we copy all elements into subarrays **L** and **R**
 - **L+R** have **n** elements
 - So total memory occupation is **2n**
- **Not in place** sorting
 - A problem only in case of extremely large arrays

```
merge(A, p, q, r)
    n_left = q - p + 1
    n_right = r - q
    L = array[n_left]
    R = array[n_right]
    for i = 0 to n_left - 1: # runtime - n/2
        L[i] = A[p + i]
    for j = 0 to n_right - 1: # runtime - n/2
        R[j] = A[q + 1 + j]
    ind_l = 0
    ind_r = 0
    for k = p to r # runtime - n
        if ind_r > n_right - 1 or L[ind_l] ≤ R[ind_r]
            A[k] = L[ind_l]
            ind_l = ind_l + 1
        else
            A[k] = R[ind_r]
            ind_r = ind_r + 1
```

Content

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Quick Sort

Quick sort is another „divide-and-conquer” sorting algorithm

- Unlike merge sort, sorts the array **in place**
- **DIVIDE: central part of the algorithm**
 - Partition the array $A[p, r]$ into two subarrays $A[p, q-1]$ and $A[q+1, r]$, such that all elements of $A[p, q-1]$ are smaller than $A[q]$ and all elements of $A[q+1, r]$ are larger than $A[q]$
 - After sorting $A[p, q-1]$ and $A[q+1, r]$ (**recursively**) the whole array is **sorted**

```
quick_sort(A, p, r)
    q = partition(A, p, r)
    quick_sort(A, p, q - 1)
    quick_sort(A, q + 1, r)
```

Quick sort: partition

```
partition(A, p, r)
    pivot = A[r]
    s = p - 1 # index of the last element smaller (or same) than pivot
    for i = p to r - 1:
        if A[i] ≤ pivot
            s = s + 1
            exchange(A[i], A[s])
    exchange(A[s+1], A[r])
    return s + 1
```

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
9	2	6	7	5	1	8	4

```
pivot = A[7] = 4
s = 0 - 1 = -1
```

```
#for loop, 1. iteration
A[0] = 9 ≤ pivot = 4 → False
```

```
#for loop, 2. iteration
A[1] = 2 ≤ pivot = 4 → True
s = s + 1 = 0
exchange A[1], A[0] (2 and 9)
```

2	9	6	7	5	1	8	4
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---

Quick sort: partition

```
partition(A, p, r)
    pivot = A[r]
    s = p - 1 # index of the last element smaller (or same) than pivot
    for i = p to r - 1:
        if A[i] ≤ pivot
            s = s + 1
            exchange(A[i], A[s])
    exchange(A[s+1], A[r])
    return s + 1
```

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
2	9	6	7	5	1	8	4

```
#for loop, 3. iteration
A[2] = 6 ≤ pivot = 4 → False
```

```
#for loop, 4. iteration
A[3] = 7 ≤ pivot = 4 → False
```

```
#for loop, 5. iteration
A[4] = 5 ≤ pivot = 4 → False
```

...

Quick sort: partition

```
partition(A, p, r)
    pivot = A[r]
    s = p - 1 # index of the last element smaller (or same) than pivot
    for i = p to r - 1:
        if A[i] ≤ pivot
            s = s + 1
            exchange(A[i], A[s])
    exchange(A[s+1], A[r])
    return s + 1
```

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
2	9	6	7	5	1	8	4

#for loop, 6. iteration
 $A[5] = 1 \leq \text{pivot} = 4 \rightarrow \text{True}$

$s = s + 1 = 1$
exchange $A[1]$, $A[5]$ (1 and 9)

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
2	1	6	7	5	9	8	4

Quick sort: partition

```
partition(A, p, r)
    pivot = A[r]
    s = p - 1 # index of the last element smaller (or same) than pivot
    for i = p to r - 1:
        if A[i] ≤ pivot
            s = s + 1
            exchange(A[i], A[s])
    exchange(A[s+1], A[r])
    return s + 1
```

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
2	1	6	7	5	9	8	4

#for loop, 7. iteration
 $A[6] = 8 \leq \text{pivot} = 4 \rightarrow \text{False}$
for loop over, $s = 1$

exchange $A[7]$ (pivot), $A[s+1 = 2]$
(6 and 4)

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
2	1	4	7	5	9	8	6

```
return 2 (s+1)
quick_sort([2,1])
quick_sort([7, 5, 9, 8, 6])
```

Quick sort: running time

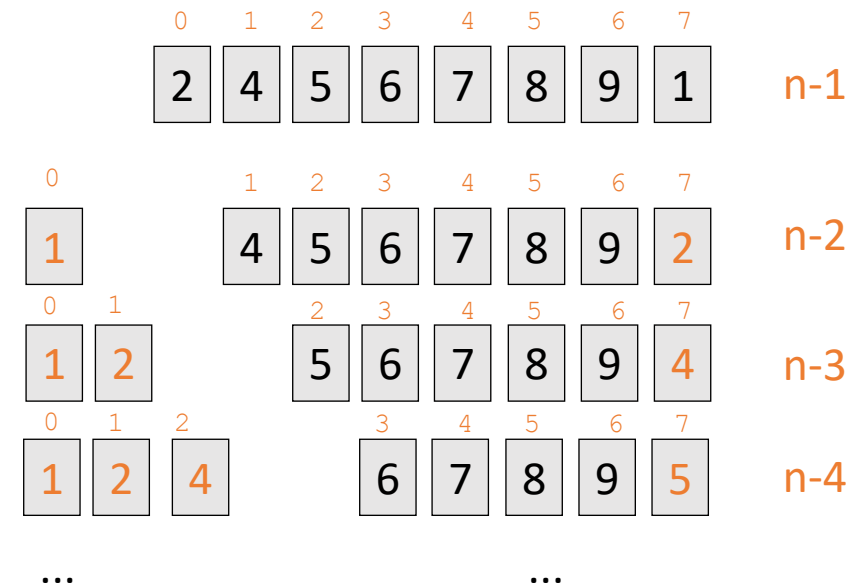
- The running time of the quick sort depends on whether the partitioning is (mostly) **balanced** or **unbalanced**
- If the partitioning is **balanced**, quick sort will have the running time of **a merge sort** (but with **in place** sorting!)
 - On average, partitioning will be balanced! **Q**: why?
 - So average runtime of quick sort is **$O(n \log n)$** !
 - Not just that, the **constants in running time are lower** for quick sort
- **Worst case scenario**
 - Running time of quick sort will be **$O(n^2)$** .
 - **Q**: why?

Quick sort: worst running time

- If $A[i] \leq \text{pivot}$ is never fulfilled
- So the partitions will be $[]$ and $A[1...r]$
- **Q:** Can you think of a worst case example for quick sort?

$$\begin{aligned} T(n) &= (n-1) + (n-2) + \dots + 2 + 1 \\ &= (n-1) * n / 2 \\ &= O(n^2) \end{aligned}$$

```
partition(A, p, r)
    pivot = A[r]
    s = p - 1
    for i = p to r - 1:
        if A[i] ≤ pivot
            s = s + 1
            exchange(A[i], A[s])
    exchange(A[s+1], A[r])
    return s + 1
```



Questions?

